GCC ATLAS

Atlas helps companies plan their first India team.

A global capability centre (GCC) is a company's own team abroad.

Company's needs → **City and provider choices** → **A decision brief**

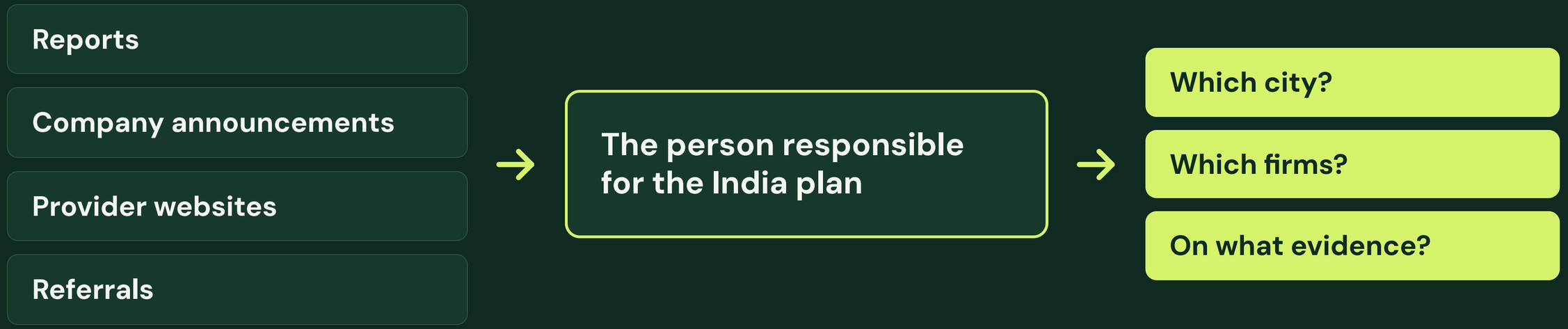
Gagan Mahajan · Product Intern assignment, Flexiple · October 2026

Open the prototype ↗

THE PROBLEM

Scattered information makes the first India plan hard to defend.

A company opening its own team in India must choose a city and firms to help. The evidence sits across reports, announcements and referrals, making options hard to compare and decisions hard to explain.



Source: Flexiple's assignment brief, and a review of Flexiple's public GCC pages on 13 Oct 2026.

WHO IS HURT

Unclear assumptions put budgets and hiring plans at risk.

HYPOTHESIS TO TEST

India lead

Must explain the shortlist to colleagues. The risk: rework before approval.

HYPOTHESIS TO TEST

Finance and hiring

Must challenge costs and staffing assumptions. The risk: uncertain budgets and staffing.

PROVIDER ESTIMATE

4–6 months

Flexiple's estimate for establishing a working entity. Not a delay caused by missing information.

Research effort and financial harm remain unmeasured.

Source: Flexiple GCC setup guide, flexiple.com/gcc/setup, read 13 Oct 2026. The two buyer risks are hypotheses to test.

TODAY'S OPTIONS

Existing sources help, but buyers must connect the pieces.

STARTING POINT	WHAT IT PROVIDES	WHAT THE BUYER STILL CHECKS
Directories and reports	Companies and benchmarks	Relevance, dates and definitions
Referrals	Someone's experience	Fit for this team
Advisers	Tailored advice	Assumptions and alternatives
Provider websites	Services and case studies	Role, results and suitability

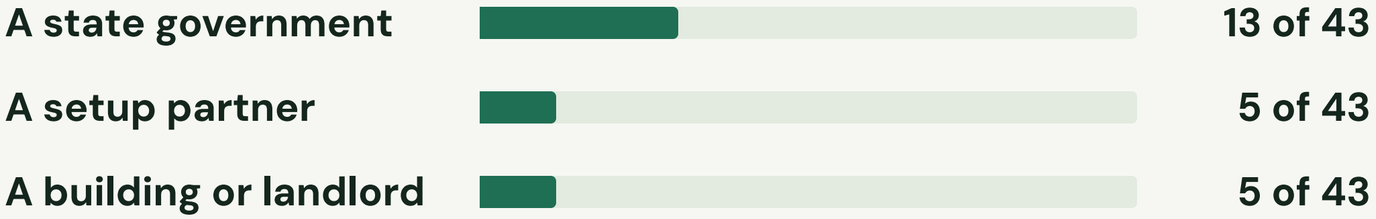
The proposed gap: a saved decision brief the buyer can check and revisit.

Sources: Flexiple GCC directory (flexiple.com/gcc/india) and setup services (flexiple.com/gcc), read 13 Oct 2026.

THE HARDEST INPUT

Provider evidence is the thinnest part of the brief.

What 43 announcements name



Categories overlap. Selected public announcements, not a census.

In our selected sample, only 5 of 43 announcements name a setup partner. That gives a starting point for investigation; it does not prove who delivered well or who was never involved.

43 announcement records; 41 company names; 42 distinct source URLs.

Source: the announcements behind Flexiple's new-centre list, flexiple.com/gcc/india. Snapshot 13 Oct 2026; counts confirmed in a 14 Oct reading of every article.

PRIORITIES

The decision brief is the best starting point.

Prioritise immediate buyer usefulness, available evidence and build feasibility.

ORDER	OPPORTUNITY	WHY THIS ORDER
1	City and provider decision brief	A complete buyer task using existing inputs
2	Better provider evidence	Strengthens the brief; needs source and client checks
3	New-centre and policy alerts	Useful later; needs reliable updating
4	Broader directories and benchmarks	Valuable foundation; public alternatives already exist

Start with a complete decision; deepen its weakest evidence next. This ranking is a hypothesis to test with buyers.

Product judgement, informed by the assignment and Flexiple's existing directory (flexiple.com/gcc/india).

START WITH ONE BUYER

The first user needs a shortlist colleagues can challenge.

A strategy or operations lead at a mid-sized global company, planning its first India team. Their job: bring city options, cost assumptions and potential providers into an internal approval discussion.

TRIGGER

Planning the first India team

USER

Strategy or operations lead

JOB

Prepare a shortlist for internal review

Initial customer hypothesis

Proposed starting segment; not an interviewed persona.

THE PRODUCT

Atlas turns research into a decision brief.

Team, budget and priorities → **City scenarios** → **Provider shortlist** → **Saved decision brief**

Choices + assumptions + sources + unanswered questions

Compare

Compare cities using the company's needs and visible assumptions.

Shortlist

Shortlist providers alongside the evidence for their involvement.

Share

Save choices, sources and questions in a report colleagues can review.

Working planner: gaganm7.github.io/gcc-atlas-flexiple-assignment/dist/planner.html

WHAT WORKS TODAY

The prototype completes a focused planning task.

Included

- Searchable source records
- Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Pune and Chennai scenarios
- Provider selection, saving and export
- Source links and labelled assumptions

Outside this prototype

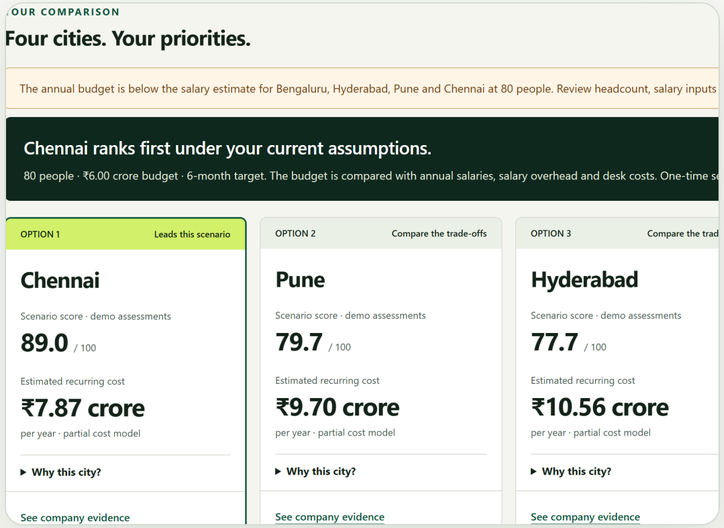
- Complete national coverage
- Proven hiring or setup feasibility
- Shared accounts or booking services
- Verified provider performance

Saved plans reopen in the same browser; the downloaded brief is how a plan is shared.

TRY THE WORKFLOW · ILLUSTRATIVE SCENARIO

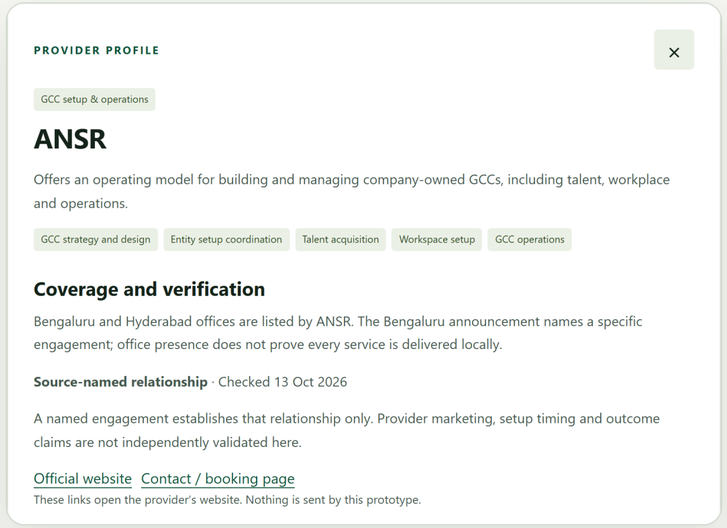
A reviewer can follow the decision from start to finish.

1 · COMPARE



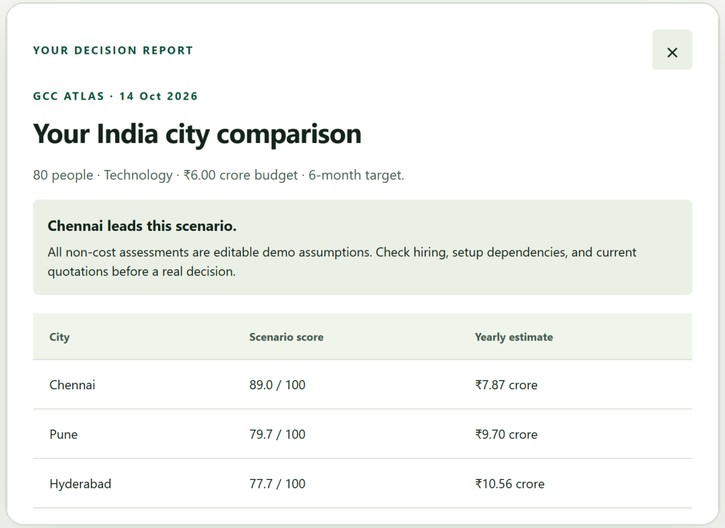
Open the planner and change a priority.

2 · INSPECT AND SELECT



Inspect assumptions, then select a provider and its evidence.

3 · SAVE AND DOWNLOAD



Save, reopen and download the combined brief.

Working prototype: gaganm7.github.io/gcc-atlas-flexiple-assignment/dist/atlas.html · screenshots from the submitted build.

FACTS AND ASSUMPTIONS

Every claim carries its receipt.

SOURCED CLAIM

A named relationship and its supporting passage, with its link, date and checking status.

ASSUMPTION

An editable city assessment or cost input, always labelled as an assumption.

OPEN QUESTION

Evidence still needed before choosing a provider. A mention shows involvement, not quality.

Software salary references do not cover every function or seniority.

Salary references: Flexiple GCC statistics and methodology (flexiple.com/gcc/statistics, flexiple.com/market/methodology).

WHY THEY WOULD USE IT

Each stakeholder gets a clearer basis for the next conversation.

STAKEHOLDER	USES TODAY	REASON TO TRY ATLAS
Entering company: operations, finance, hiring	Reports, referrals, spreadsheets	One brief with choices and assumptions
Existing India teams and advisers	Separate project research	Reusable planning context
Setup, legal, tax, hiring, payroll and office firms Future contribution opportunity	Websites and referrals	Evidence attached to a relevant buyer need
State agencies Future contribution opportunity	Policy pages and outreach	Dated information in the buyer's context

Stakeholders from the assignment brief. Contribution workflows are proposals, not current features.

WHY FLEXIPLE WOULD BUILD THIS

Useful briefs could create better setup conversations for Flexiple.

Free research and planning → **Buyer chooses an introduction** → **Paid setup or hiring engagement**

- Free research helps buyers prepare their India plan.
- Optional introductions could lead to paid setup or hiring work.
- Test paid research later; never sell higher evidence rankings.

LATER HYPOTHESIS

Paid research for complex decisions.

Proposed model; demand and pricing untested

Flexiple's existing GCC services: flexiple.com/gcc.

MEASURE A USEFUL DECISION

Success means buyers can explain and use their brief.

USEFULNESS

Briefs used in a real follow-up ÷ completed briefs

Does the brief support the next internal or adviser discussion?

UNDERSTANDING

Users separating facts from assumptions ÷ users tested

Can the buyer explain the shortlist and its assumptions?

TRUST

Unsupported claims found in review, with correction status

Track evidence errors before claiming time or cost savings.

Establish baselines before setting targets. No production analytics yet.

WHAT WE NEED TO LEARN

Demand, evidence quality and trust still need testing.

DEMAND

Buyers may prefer an adviser to preparing a brief themselves.

Test: observe a real planning task.

EVIDENCE

Public mentions may never give enough useful provider evidence.

Test: check source claims and seek client confirmation.

TRUST

Illustrative rankings and commercial incentives could undermine trust.

Test: check that users understand assumptions; disclose commercial links.

Proposed tests, not research already completed

Limits recorded during the project's review of Flexiple's public pages and its own prototype.

PROPOSED NEXT 90 DAYS

Validate the decision task before expanding the product.

DAYS 1–30

Observe buyers and test the brief

Proceed if the task matters.

DAYS 31–60

Improve weak evidence and repeat the workflow

Proceed if buyers understand the evidence.

DAYS 61–90

Test introductions if buyers use the brief

Proceed if the brief supports real conversations.

Proposed sequence; dependent on findings

Author’s proposed plan. Day ranges are planning choices, not observed results.

GCC ATLAS

Open the brief and challenge the reasoning.

Compare a scenario, inspect its evidence and download the brief.

City choices + provider evidence + visible assumptions → **A decision brief**

Try the prototype ↗ **Download the deck**